Chat Communications That Followed

Petitioner sent the following chat message to the coach:

> *"Total screw up with my boy today. I want to speak to who is running the meet. The only fair thing to do is run heat 2 of the 50 meter breast again."*

The coach (Daiki Sato) did not respond directly. Instead, he brought the Head Coach and Ms. Howard into the chat without first speaking to Petitioner.

Daiki Sato's Response

> *"Hi Stephen, I received your message and understand your frustration regarding [redacted] 50m Breaststroke entry. The issue was an honest mistake. Despite this, the Meet Director and Head Official worked together to find an available lane for [redacted] so that he could still compete. At a meet of this size and level, accommodations like this are not typically made, and they should be recognized as a courtesy rather than an expectation. While I understand your concern for your athlete, I need to address your conduct during the situation. In the future, if there is an issue, please come directly to me rather than confronting meet officials. The Meet Director and Head Official are volunteers who dedicate a significant amount of time to providing athletes with a quality competition experience. They deserve to be treated with respect, even when frustrations arise. Additionally, parents are not permitted on the pool deck or to approach officials regarding meet operations. This is a direct violation of the parent code of conduct and cannot happen again. Moving forward, any concerns should be brought directly to me, and I will work through the appropriate channels to address them. Thank you for your cooperation and understanding. Best regards."*

Petitioner's Response

> *"I have brought the issue to you and they need to run the race again. [redacted] went to the official and they did nothing. This race has got to be raced again. That is the only fair thing to do."*

Melissa Howard's First Response

> *"Mr. Jordan, That's not how this works. He got to race and that is acceptable. Most of the time at meets of this level he wouldn't even get the opportunity to compete. Mistakes happen and this was not a mistake at the hands of the adults and they fixed it as best a they could. I understand the frustration but you also need to know that officials have the right to remove parents and spectators from the meet and if they do so because you are not abiding by the expectations, that is out of Coach Daiki's control. Thank you for understanding."*

Petitioner's Follow-Up

> *"What do you mean meets of this level he wouldn't get to compete. He is AA swimmer and he was racing for his TAGS time. They should be happy [redacted] is racing. Now the right thing is for the race to be run again. That is the fair thing to do. Now I am requesting that in the morning that me, Daiki, and the person running the meet, meet with me. I think they are happy Ironhorse is here and I believe some accommodation should be made."*

Melissa Howard's Second Response

> *"A meeting won't be necessary. And accommodations were made by finding another spot for him. [redacted] getting to swim is a win and that the only time events are re-swum is if there is a malfunction with the timing system. Whole events are never just re-swum because one swimmer was in the wrong heat and lane."*

Petitioner's Closing Statement

> *"I am going to let this drop this time, but coaches need to make certain that their swimmers are in the right event, heat and lane. You have to double check young kids."*

Daiki Sato's Final Statement

> *"Yes, that is what the pre-race communication is for. [redacted] and I talked before his race so he knew what heat and lane he needed to be. This was an accident and an isolated incident."*